



Discussion portion

To start class, my professor opted to begin with our weekly Friday test, which is portrayed in my first image. We usually do group tests with groups being decided earlier in the week and then randomized the next, however, this week she opted to start with individual tests. There wasn't much active learning, for good reason, but students occasionally raised their hands to ask questions about the material, and I found her responses helpful as they didn't solve the problem, and elicited ideas for the students to think about. After around 10 minutes of the individual quizzes, the students were allowed to rejoin their original groups to compare their answers. I found splitting the groups up to be a confusing idea to start, but once the students rejoined their groups, I saw how they interacted with each other and felt the conversations were great examples of active learning. The students were engaged in the conversation and walked through their answers and how they came about them. Some students weren't as involved in the conversation as others, and I would have liked my teacher to have noticed the stragglers more, as I thought they were pretty noticeable. I found that during the first weeks of College-Algebra, when I was in a student, I could ride the shoulders of my classmates who were in my group, and it didn't necessarily promote active learning.

Finally, for the rest of the class period, my teacher lectured using examples on the whiteboard and occasionally brought notes up on the screen in our classroom. This was the most notable section that lacked active learning; however, I didn't find it to be completely devoid of it either. My teacher usually calls on students to answer questions, which she did during class on that particular day. The problem with today specifically was that she didn't go around the room asking each student, but rather asked the class as a whole, which, of course, allowed a small handful of students to completely disengage from the conversation. In my next meeting, I'd like to bring up the students I noticed that weren't heavily involved in both the test discussions and the lecture to help my teacher give them "special attention" in the sense that she can make sure they're understanding the concepts presented to them. I also want to make her aware that she should ask around the room more often rather than to the class as a unit.

One more thing of note is that, typically, our classes are split between lecturing and group work, in which the students work within their groups to solve small assignments that correlate with the lecture. This is usually the most involved the students are within the subject, and something I found very helpful as a student in facilitating my knowledge of college-level algebra. Unfortunately, on Fridays, there isn't usually enough time for group work due to tests and lecturing. This particular Friday had about 5-10 minutes of groupwork, yet I forgot to get an image of it because I was bouncing around so much (whoops!) Once again, I found the students had very fruitful conversations that

elicited a great learning environment in which my teacher and I could enter if help was needed. I spotted one student who seemed to be disengaged from the group work, and I urged them to take a turn writing the problems on the board. After that, it seemed they were more active in the conversation.

All around, I found this activity helpful in finding my style of approaching students by urging active participation during group activities. I want my role to be represented as an equal to the students, so they feel more comfortable asking questions without the worry that they may feel dumb asking our teacher. Finally, I want to get better at explaining the process of the material while also not handing out answers to students. This is my biggest flaw at the moment, and I hope to overcome it as the semester goes on.